

9.1 - Foreign Policy

Artificial Intelligence Policy

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S2026

Reorienting and Taking Stock

- We are halfway through the class!
- Today, we'll talk about geopolitics and foreign policy, but also recenter ourselves after the first half of the course (and after the week off).
- Where have we been, and what have we learned?
- As we make our transition from talking about the philosophy, technology, and development of AI to talking about implications and impacts, what has been surprising?
- Where do we *most* need policy, and what areas of AI most call out for intervention or support?

Think

- *What is AI's role in national defense and security?*
- *What responsibility do AI firms have to their "home" countries? Are they like defense contractors? Should the government have a special role in controlling AI technology and approving AI military technology sales?*

Read

- Horowitz et al, "[AI, the International Balance of Power, and National Security Strategy](#)". *The Oxford Handbook of AI Governance*
 - [Syracuse library link](#)
- Make sure to be familiar with the Anthropic/Department of Defense story for class discussion (see possible sources below).

Listen:

- *Not required, but recommended:* Dean Ball, 2026. “[Why the Pentagon Wants to Destroy Anthropic](#)”, *The Ezra Klein Show*, New York Times. Also see [Youtube link](#)

Browse:

- The recent Anthropic/Pentagon dustup is relevant and interesting from a variety of dimensions.
 - The core story:
 - * [“Anthropic Refuses Pentagon’s Proposal to Loosen AI Guardrails](#). Wall Street Journal.
 - * [OpenAI announces Pentagon deal after Trump bans Anthropic](#). NPR.
 - * [Pentagon Officially Notifies Anthropic It Is a ‘Supply Chain Risk’](#). New York Times.
 - * [A ‘Fight About Vibes’ Drove the Pentagon’s Breakup with Anthropic](#). Wall Street Journal.
 - * [Anthropic Sues U.S. Defense Department, Pete Hegseth for Targeting the Company](#). Wall Street Journal.
 - * [A Guide to the Pentagon’s Dance With Anthropic and OpenAI](#). New York Times.
 - A counter take: [Anthropic and Alignment](#), 2026. Stratechery blog.
 - Side effects:
 - * [The Pentagon-Anthropic Spat Is Good for China](#) Wall Street Journal.
 - * [Anthropic’s Standoff With the Pentagon Shakes Up AI Talent Race](#) Wall Street Journal.
 - * [OpenAI and Google employees rush to Anthropic’s defense in DOD lawsuit](#). Tech Crunch.
 - * [“Anthropic’s AI tool Claude central to U.S. campaign in Iran, amid a bitter feud”](#) Washington Post.
 - Two podcasts:
 - * Mike Masnick, 2026. “[Anthropic doesn’t trust the Pentagon, and neither should you](#)”, *Decoder* with Nilay Patel, The Verge. Also see [Youtube video link](#)
- [“What Google’s Return to Defense AI Means”](#). Defense One.
- [“Elon Musk Moves Against the Russians in Ukraine”](#). The Atlantic.
- Some additional tidbits on China-US competition:
 - [“AI experts return from China stunned: The U.S. grid is so weak, the race may already be over”](#). Fortune.
 - [“China’s Rare Earth Restrictions Aim to Beat U.S. at Its Own Game”](#) NYTimes.

Additional Resources

- Himmelreich, 2019. “[Responsibility for Killer Robots](#)” *Ethical Theory and Moral Practice*

Tip

- “ Read”, “ Listen”, and/or “ Watch” items are required content for the day, and should be read/heard/watched before class on that day.
- “ Browse” items should be briefly looked at but do not need to be read deeply unless you want to
- “ Additional Resources” do not need to be looked at; they are there to serve, if useful, as further references for your debates, final projects, and general edification later.